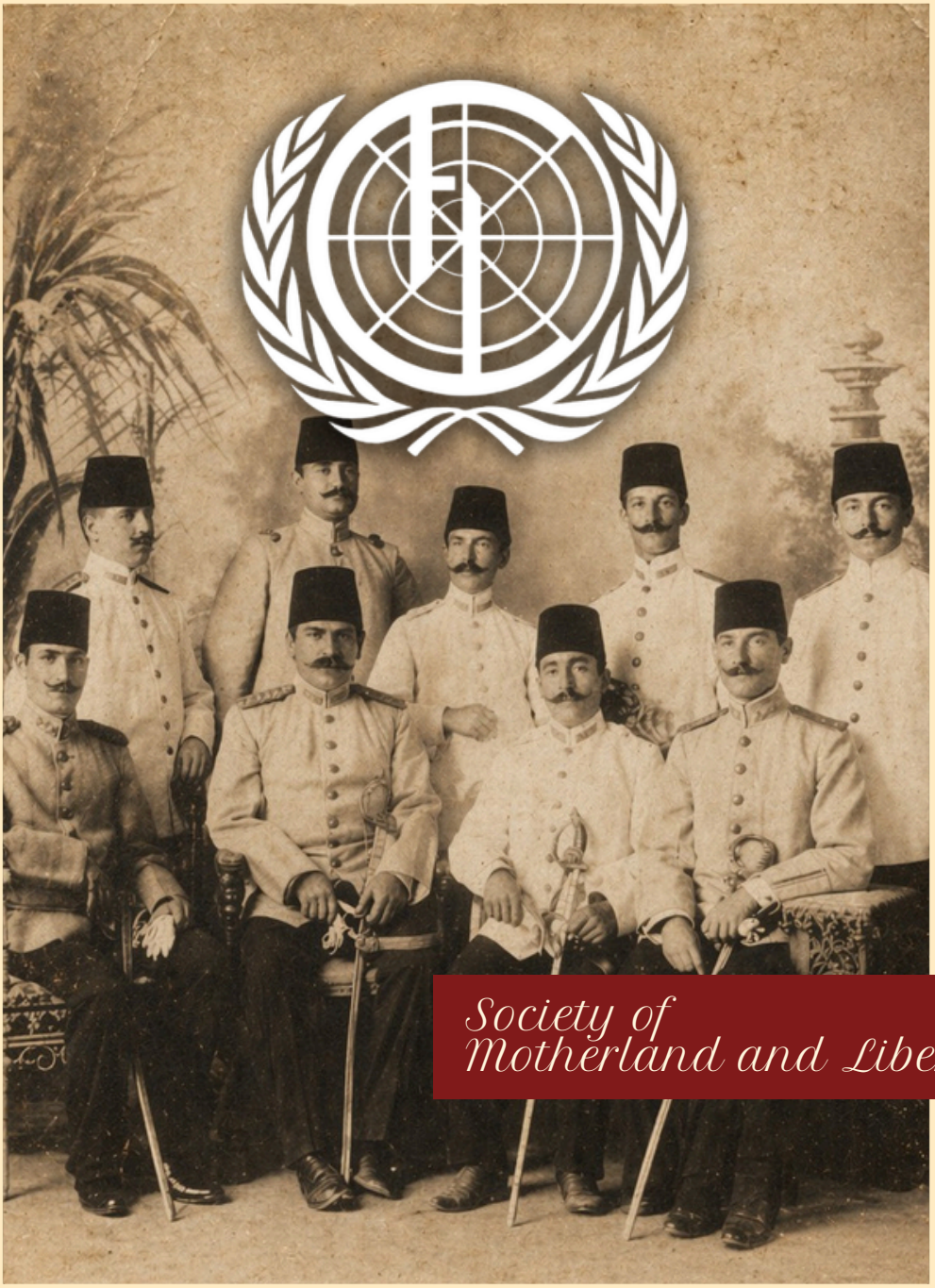
CFLMUN'26



Society of Motherland and Liberty

Güven Doğan | Tuna Ergene

STUDY GUIDE

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1. Letter From the Secretary General

Dear Delegates,

Welcome to CFLMUN'26 everyone! My name is Sümeyra, and I have the honour of serving as the Secretary General at this conference. I'm filled with excitement and happiness. Also, I'd like to thank my Head of Crisis Mete Mercan, my Under Secretary Genereal Güven Doğan and my Crisis Team Member Tuna Ergene for helping to organize the committee.

On the Historical Crisis Committee, HCC, you could speak about the History of the Turks. To be honest, if I joined CFLMUN'26 as a delegate, this committee would be my first choice.

Also, I want to say thank each and every one of you for choosing to be a part of this committee. Your presence and participation are what will make it truly meaningful. I look forward to seeing you all between on May 1st and 3rd, ready to challenge perspectives, defend positions, and most importantly, enjoy the experience.

Wishing you all the best of luck. *Let's shaping the future in the light of diplomacy!*

Warm regards,

Sümeyra Gülsüm Çolak

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2. Letter From the Head of Crisis

Dear Delegates,

I would like to extend a warm welcome to all of you to the “Society of Motherland and Liberty” Crisis Committee of CFLMUN’26.

My name is Mete MERCAN, and I am proud to represent this committee as Head of Crisis. I will do my very best to create an environment filled with unforgettable

experiences and opportunities for you to showcase your skills as crisis delegates, and I will dedicate my full attention to this endeavor.

This guide will serve as your handbook for this committee. Preparing for the committee should first and foremost be for your benefit, because you cannot build anything without a foundation. In the committee, you will work as a member of a secret society within the turbulent environment of the 1900s Ottoman Empire. It is important to us that you not only embody a character but also fully immerse yourselves in that era.

And never forget: *The future is in your hands.*

Mete Mercan

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3. Letter From the Under Secretary General

Most esteemed participants.

I hope this letter finds you in high spirits. It is my utmost pleasure to welcome you to the historical crisis committee of the CFLMUN. I, as Güven Doğan, am thrilled to serve as the under-secretary-general of this committee.

At the beginning of the 20th century, the Ottoman Empire was in a difficult situation, facing numerous rebellions, internal turmoil, and the near-total loss of the Sultan's authority. Young officers within the army believed that pro-Sultan Pashas had obtained their ranks through corruption and that these men, who had seen almost no real combat, could not adequately command the army. Therefore, various ideological movements developed to rescue the Ottoman Empire from this situation, and officers began to form groups among themselves. Among these groups was Mustafa Kemal, who had recently been exiled to Damascus for separatist activities and who, approximately 20 years later, would lead the War of Independence that would establish the modern Republic of Turkey. Far from abandoning or being intimidated by his separatist activities, Mustafa Kemal intensified his activities in Damascus and founded a society there: the "Homeland and Freedom Society." This society managed to open cells in several cities, primarily Damascus, Beirut, Acre, and Thessaloniki. However, due to the growth of the Committee of Union and Progress and the potential problems it could create for other smaller societies, a decision was made to join the Committee of Union and Progress en masse. You, the delegates, will control what might happen before this decision by the Society of Fatherland and Freedom, and you will shape the course of history and determine the fate of this society..

Dear delegates I hope to meet you all and have a great committee as we decide and shape the future of Society of Motherland and Liberty and people of Ottoman Empire. I wish you all good luck on your journey at this historical crisis committee and may the most radical revolutionary win! And on a side note; no top secret has ever ruined any committee...

Also, if you have any questions or a place you don’t understand, please don’t hesitate to contact me.

Sincere gratitude’s,

Güven Doğan

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4. Introduction

By the end of the 19th century, the Ottoman Empire had entered a period of deep crisis. Military defeats, territorial losses, and economic problems had severely weakened the state's power. At the same time, political tensions within the empire were increasing, and intellectuals and reformists were beginning to question the Sultan's authority.

Following the suspension of the Ottoman Constitution in 1878, Sultan Abdul Hamid II established a highly centralized and authoritarian government. Although this government provided stability for a while, it created widespread dissatisfaction among reformist circles.

One of the groups most affected by this situation was the young officers who had received training in modern military schools. Many of these officers were influenced by the ideas of constitutional government, nationalism, and modernization.

In 1905, one of these officers, Mustafa Kemal, founded a secret society called Fatherland and Freedom in Damascus. This society aimed to defend constitutional government and oppose the Sultan's authoritarian rule. Although its membership was limited, this organization would later become part of a broader movement leading to the 1908 Young Turk Revolution, becoming one of the leading groupings under the Committee of Union and Progress.

Therefore, members of the Fatherland and Freedom Society, who opposed both the military's involvement in politics and the Sultan's attitudes, should seek innovative solutions to these problems.

5. Glossary

Constitutionalism

A political ideology that argues that state authority should be limited by a constitution.

Jon Turks

A reform movement in the Ottoman Empire composed of intellectuals and soldiers who wanted political reforms.

Autocracy

A form of government in which all political power is exercised by a single person.

Society of Ittıhad and Terakki

A political organization that played a significant role in the re-enactment of the Ottoman Constitution in 1908.

Secret Society

An organization that conducted its activities secretly due to political pressures.

Hamidiye Regime

II. The reign of Abdülhamid II was a period of strong central authority and intense political control.

6. Historical Background

6.1 Decline of the Ottoman Empire

Throughout the 19th century, the Ottoman Empire faced numerous political, military, and economic problems. Defeats in wars against European states weakened the empire's military strength and led to significant territorial losses.

At the same time, nationalist movements began to emerge among various ethnic groups within the empire. These movements further complicated the political situation and put serious pressure on the Ottoman administration.

6.2 Rise of Reformist Thought

In order to find solutions to these problems, various reform movements emerged in the 19th century. The Tanzimat reforms, which began in 1839, aimed to modernize the Ottoman administration and legal system.

These reforms also led to Ottoman intellectuals becoming acquainted with European political ideas. Ideas such as liberalism, constitutional government, and nationalism gradually influenced the intellectual world of many young Ottoman bureaucrats and officers.

6.3 II. Abdulhamid and the Suspension of the Constitution

In 1876, the Ottoman Empire briefly adopted its first constitution. However, only two years later, Abdulhamid II suspended the constitution, dissolved the parliament, and established a centralized government.

Although the Sultan implemented some modernization policies, the government resorted to intense censorship and intelligence activities to suppress opposition.

This environment paved the way for the emergence of secret political organizations among intellectuals and military circles.

6.4 The Emergence of Secret Opposition Organizations

In the late 19th and early 20th centuries, many secret societies emerged within the Ottoman Empire. The members of these organizations generally consisted of students, intellectuals, and military officers.One of these societies was the Society for the Fatherland and Freedom, founded by Mustafa Kemal and his friends. The society aimed to spread the idea that the Ottoman Empire could only survive through constitutional governance and political reforms.

7. Internal Situation of the Ottoman Empire

7.1 Autocracy and the Hamidiye Regime

Abdul Hamid II had established tight control over the imperial administration. The government used a vast intelligence network and censorship system to monitor the opposition.

While this system provided stability in the short term, it created growing discontent among the educated elite.

7.2 Intellectual Opposition and Young Officers

Some of the most critical voices in the empire came from military schools and educational institutions. Students and young officers were greatly influenced by European political ideas**.**Most of them were believing reforms are necessary for countries to remain.

7.3 Secret Societies and Political Organization

Due to political pressures, opposition groups often conducted their activities secretly. Members were usually organized into small cells through trusted individuals.

Although these organizations were small in number, they played an important role in spreading reform ideas within the army and bureaucracy.

8. Geopolitical Situation

8.1 European States and the Eastern Question

Throughout the 19th century, European states closely followed the situation of the Ottoman Empire. The weakening of the empire raised the question of how its territories would be divided among the great powers.

This issue became known in international politics as the Eastern Question.

8.2 Nationalism in the Balkans

Nationalist movements in the Balkans became one of the greatest threats to Ottoman authority. Some regions gained independence or autonomy, while others began to put forward similar demands.

These developments further weakened the stability of the empire.

8.3 The Position of the Great Powers

Russia

Russia claimed to be the protector of the Orthodox peoples in the Balkans and frequently supported nationalist movements against Ottoman rule.

United Kingdom

Britain generally supported the territorial integrity of the Ottoman Empire so that the balance of power in Europe could be maintained.

France

France had cultural and political influence over the Ottoman Empire and supported its modernization efforts. Germany

Towards the end of the 19th century, military and economic relations between Germany and the Ottoman Empire had grown increasingly stronger.

9. Key Characters

Mustafa Kemal

Kolağası Mustafa Kemal (1881-1938) is a young Turkish officer in the early 1900's. He is a slightly aggressive but measured, clever and diligent person. He is good at defending theories and doctrines of defence. In the Society of Motherland and Liberty, he is holding the position of main founder and manager of the society. His missions are to manage the society, take decisions that proects the community. His star has not shone yet.

The delegate of Mustafa Kemal should be interested in great speeches because of his ability of persuasion. At war, he should be commanding defensive armies or positions to use the benefits of Mustafa Kemal.

Doctor Mustafa Bey

Doctor Mustafa Cantekin (1878-1955) is a Turkish Doctor Officer and then a politician. In these years, he was exiled to Damascus for his political activites. At there, he met with Mustafa Kemal who is exiled too to make him stay far to Constantinople. Their friendship started the day they met. He is a good speaker and a smart person. They sweared to a gun with some of friends of them and formed the Society of Motherland and Liberty.

The delegate of Mustafa Cantekin should be doing a lot of secret speeches and use his knowledge about politics. If he is a commander, this will increase the recovery rate of the units he commands and is responsible for. Write directives about secret press releases, collect new officers to the society. At war, use his ability of being a doctor and wisdom to set up a field hospital.

Lütfi Müfid Özdeş

Lütfi Müfid Özdeş (1874-1940) is a Turkish officer and then a politician. His friendship with Mustafa Kemal and Ali Fuad Bey started at Constantinople and grown up at Damascus. After they came to Damascus they decided to form a Society named Motherland and Liberty. He is good at perform the commands that given to him. That makes him a great mission man. He is stable and suitable for long term conflicts.

Delegate of Lütfi Müfit Özdeş should be interested of solving crisis that came up with updates. He should join every joint directive he can. He is good at getting along with people and that makes him perfect for collecting people to the society

(Lütfi Müfit Özdeş- He is at the rightmost)

Ali Fuat Cebesoy

Ali Fuat Cebesoy (1882-1968) a Turkish officer and then a politician. He is brave, bold and slightly aggressive person at his young ages. He was classmate with Mustafa Kemal at Military School years. He became the first commander to effectively start the Turkish War of Independence by ordering the firing on and halting the British troops advancing from Izmit to Ankara during the occupation of Türkiye. He is not married to die, a rumor says that it's beceause of he is married with motherland. Beceause of his ability of investigation and braveness, he is a good commander and society member.

Delegate of Ali Fuat Cebesoy should do the dangerous and risky tasks of the society. With his daredevil personality, he will be more prone to avoid dangers and fix the problems of the directive than the other allocations. To use his benefits fully, move with him at the positions you think that is hopeless. As the nature of his, you maybe do a miracle.

Ali Fethi Bey

Ali Fethi Bey (1880-1943) is a Turkish officer and then a diplomat and politician. He was one of the secret supporters of Society of Motherland and Liberty that some sources says that he never joined that society. He is a social and persuasive person. That makes him a perfect person to use to get supporters of the Turkish public and foreign governments. With these supporter governments revolution will be easier and stronger. Beceause he is not a clear participant of the Society of Motherland and Liberty but Ittıhads, he can be used as a spy at the Society of İttihad and Terakki.

The delegate of Fethi Bey should first decide he will continue to joining process to İttihad and Terakki or stop it and join the Society of Motherland and Liberty. If he chooses to continue, at 1908, he will be a member of Ittıhads and Jon Turks and will have chance to used as a spy but cannot join and declare his real opinions on public and if he does mistakes he can be under arrest.

Hüsrev Sami Bey

Hüsrev Sami Bey (1884-1943) or Sami Bey, is a Turkish officer that graduated from Naval Engineering School. He was a farmer in childhood and he is a smart, well known person. He is good at building and planning. Moreover beceause of he worked at so much jobs and responsibilities, he is a versatile person.

Delegate of Hüsrev Sami Bey should be helping to constructions, naval battles and anything about sea. Beceause of he is good at planning, you should take responsibility on the preparation tasks of the directives or you can use the benefits of it on your own directives. (The benefits would be a stronger preparation of war. And as Baldwin the IV said, you cannot win a battle you have not prepared for.)

Hakkı Baha Pars

Hakkı Baha Pars (1879-1942) is a Turkish officer then educator and manager. He is one of the closest friends of Mustafa Kemal from his first years of being an officer and collectivism

years. Like Fethi Bey, he is one of the members of the society who is not a direct participant. Hakkı Baha Pars, a founding member of the Ottoman Freedom Society, was not only intelligent and shrewd, but also a good administrator. Although their communication weakened after Mustafa Kemal was exiled to Damascus, they remained very close friends, very close that to the point where they would risk their lives for each other and their motherland without thinking...

The delegate of Baha Pars should behave like Fethi Bey. He can choose to be a spy or be a direct member of the Society of Motherland and Liberty. If he chooses to remain in his historical conditions, in 1906 Octaber, he would initially be one of the founding members of the Ottoman Freedom Society, and later, when the society joined the Committee of Union and Progress, he would become a member of that organization. In these time of period, he will be a teacher at Military School at Constantinople. To get fully benefits from your features, you should be learning what is going on in the government and military school with directives and send it to Society of Motherland and Liberty. Moreover, you can secretly collect members to Society at Military School from students. After they gradutuated, Society will gain a really big population at Ottoman Empire. But delegate should be aware of the Ittıhat and Terakki Society's supporters in order to not get arrested. However, after you decided to join the Society of Motherland and Liberty truly, you need to be in management, education and propaganda tasks to get fully benefits of your allocation

Hüseyin Hüsnü Emir Bey

Hüseyin Hüsnü Bey (1883-1958) is a Turkish officer and author. As he born in Gaza, he has a population in there who's supporting him as a great officer. He is a good commander and Professional soldier. Therefore, he will see all the advantages in the war and will not hesitate to use them. Although fascism has not yet been established as an ideology, Hüseyin Emir Bey is a proponent of fascism. He also has an admiration, even a kind of affection, for the Germans. There is no doubt that he will succeed in gaining support from the Germans with the right moves. He is one of the first friends of Mustafa Kemal after his exile.

The delegate of Hüseyin Emir Bey should be very active at battles. To fully utilize Hüseyin Emir Bey's qualities, keep him among as many officers and soldiers as possible. As long as he is on duty, he will continue to gain supporters for the Patriot and Freedom Society. Being a writer, he has a strong writing style and will perform much more effectively in press releases.